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Overcoming OCP Adoption Barriers in European Data Centers

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OCP BRONZE™ Member

OCP Experience Center

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OPEN Compute Project

SOLUTION PROVIDER®

OCP Experience Center Nuremberg, DE

OCP Experience Center Berlin, DE

- Managed Hosting, Cloud & Colocation provider based in Germany
- **OpenStack** based cloud for IaaS offering
- Both **Hosted OCP recognized hardware** as selfhosted offering
- Teams located in **Hamburg**, Berlin and Nuremberg, Germany
- Company focus is on **Open Source** and **Sustainability**
- OCP member and Solution Provider since **2023**

- ScaleUp operates an **OCP Experience Center** in **Nuremberg** and **Berlin**, Germany

What got us Hooked on OCP

- **Christoph**:
  - Running Hosting company
  - Looking for more efficient system, preferably less vendor lock in
  - Bought 2 racks as test-drive
- **Jeroen**:
  - Wanted to watercool servers
  - Couldn’t get the flexibility in design & controls from an OEM
  - Got my hands on a couple of units on Ebay

Our journey so far

- First racks about 4 years ago for a POC
- Moved a big part of the workload in
- OCP Experience center Berlin: 2023
- OCP Experience center Nuremberg: 2025
- First customers on OCP hardware:
  Grid provider, university, E-Commerce company
  (all in Germany)



Not just taking, also contributing

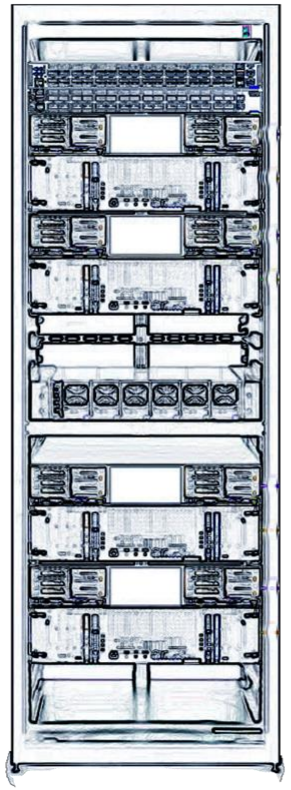
- 2 Experience centers
  - Berlin
  - Nuremberg including “Liquid Lab”
- OCP Marketplace:
  - 3 offerings on “Integrated Solutions & Professional Services”
  - Solution Provider for 14 products





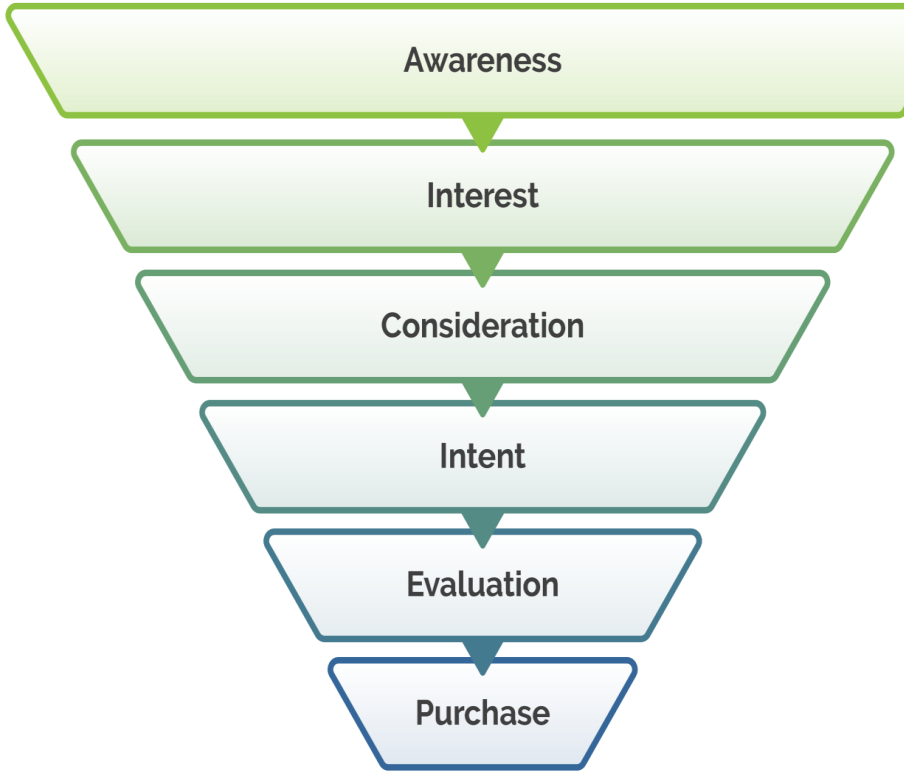
The advantages of OCP for Europe

- Power is expensive: Scope 2
  - DC distribution, 6 PSU’s versus 60
  - Higher U’s, higher heatsinks and larger fans
  - Watercooling standardized
  - Higher inlet temperatures
- Scope 3
- Less vendor lock in
- Open BMC & Firmware: More control & Audit-ability
- Longer lifecycle (EoL determined by customer, not vendor)



The OCP sales Funnel

- Not every phase has the same difficulty
- Awareness: Uphill battle
- Interest: Easiest phase
- Consideration:
- Intent:
- Evaluation Support network?
- Purchase Small deployments are challenging



Awareness

- Perceived as hyperscaler-only
- Vendor marketing spending?
- Low brand recognition
- Enterprise IT buyers rarely encounter it

Interest

- Value proposition sells itself: efficiency, density, cost, no lock-in.
- Sustainability reporting duties as a concrete driver
- Engineers dream, how to carry that over to procurement..?

Consideration

- Existing 19" estates, floor loading, ceiling & door height
- Colocation contracts often come with 19” racks
- Skills gap: no in-house experience with OpenBMC, bus bars, or ODM-style integration.
- Risk gap: Where is my 5 year 24/7 support and 4 hr response time?

Intent

- Financing & Leasing from the OEM’s is difficult to match
- Migrations eat the first years’ savings

Evaluation

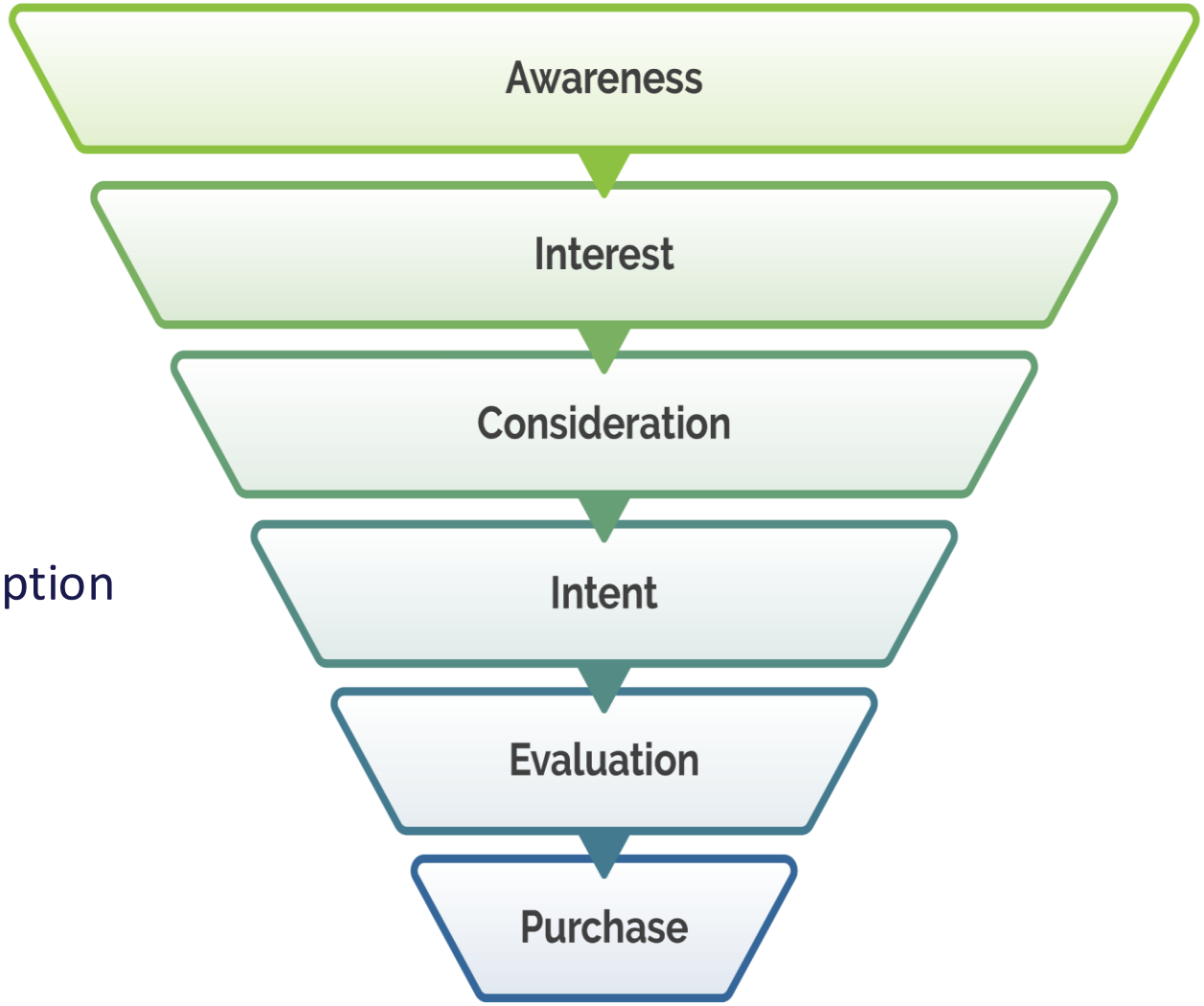
- Few European integrators and reseller channel
- Warranty, SLA and spare-parts logistics not matching a four-hour OEM support contract.
- Limited local test labs or demo racks to trial before committing.
- Firmware and lifecycle support ownership is ambiguous

Purchase

- ODM minimum order quantities
- Pricing advantage erodes when you’re only buying a couple of servers
- Not so many stocking distributors
- Tenders and public-sector procurement rules struggle with multi-vendor, spec-based buying.

Call to action

- Include OCP in your marketing mix
- More content for those who need it
- OCP must be easier to purchase & service
- More integrated OCP solutions, more financing option
- More transparency in updates & Service
- Better support/service options



Increase the EU adoption:

- Get the name out
- Build the support network
- Visit an OCP Experience center:
  - Berlin
  - Nuremberg
- Join the EMEA workstream

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Questions?

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